GOOGLE ADS

Developer Documentation

Beginner to Intermediate

Campaign Types • Ads • Keywords • API Concepts • GAQL • Reporting • Automation

Scope of this document

This version combines the earlier Google Ads learning material with the campaign-type explanation and the Google Ads vs Google AdSense distinction. Project structure and environment/setup instructions are intentionally excluded.

Version note: Google Ads API v25 is the current major API generation at the time of this document.

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1. Google Ads in simple terms

Google Ads is Google's advertising platform. An advertiser creates campaigns, defines audiences or keywords, supplies ad assets, chooses budgets and bidding approaches, and pays according to the campaign and billing model. The Google Ads API lets software manage many of these objects programmatically instead of requiring every task to be completed manually in the Google Ads UI.

From a developer point of view, the API is best understood as a collection of resources and services. Your application can create, read, update, remove, and report on resources such as campaigns, budgets, ad groups, ads, keywords, targeting criteria, assets, conversion actions, and performance metrics.

```
Advertiser
  |
  v
Google Ads
  |
  +-- Campaign
     +-- Budget
     +-- Targeting
     +-- Ad Group / Asset Group
        +-- Keywords or Audiences
        +-- Ads / Assets
```

2. Google Ads vs Google AdSense

This distinction is important. Google Ads is primarily the advertiser side: a business spends money to promote its products or services. Google AdSense is a publisher monetization product: a website or other eligible publisher makes advertising space available and earns revenue from ads served there.

Product	Who uses it?	Main purpose	Simple example
Google Ads	Advertiser	Create and manage advertising campaigns	A SaaS company spends ₹1,000/day promoting its product.
Google AdSense	Publisher / website owner	Monetize available ad space	A blog displays ads and earns publisher revenue.

A Display campaign is one important way an advertiser can reach users beyond Google Search. Ads may be shown on eligible websites and apps across Google's advertising inventory. A site using AdSense can be part of the ecosystem, but Display advertising is broader than “ads shown only through AdSense websites.”

Advertiser
|
| Google Ads campaign
v
Google advertising systems
|
v
Eligible website / app inventory
|
v
User sees an advertisement

Easy memory rule

Google Ads = “I want to advertise.” Google AdSense = “I have eligible content/space and want to monetize it.”

3. Core Google Ads concepts

Concept	Meaning
Account / Customer	The Google Ads account that contains campaigns, settings, billing context, and other resources.
Manager Account	An account used to manage other Google Ads accounts, common for agencies and multi-account organizations.
Customer ID	The identifier of a Google Ads account; API requests operate on a specific customer context.
Campaign	The high-level advertising container that determines a campaign type and major settings.
Campaign Budget	The budget resource associated with a campaign. Google Ads represents monetary values in micros in the API.
Ad Group	A group of related ads and targeting/keywords, commonly used by Search and other campaign types.
Keyword	A search-targeting term or phrase used mainly by Search campaigns.
Ad	The advertising message/creative shown to users, depending on campaign and ad type.
Asset	Reusable ad content such as text, images, logos, video, or other supported creative components.
Conversion	An action valuable to the advertiser, such as a lead, purchase, sign-up, or other tracked business result.
Impression	A recorded opportunity in which an ad is shown.
Click	A user interaction with an ad that Google records as a click.
CTR	Click-through rate: clicks divided by impressions.
CPC	Cost per click; the average amount paid per click when using a CPC-based metric/model.
CPA	Cost per acquisition/action; a common efficiency metric based on conversions.
ROAS	Return on ad spend; commonly expressed as conversion value divided by advertising cost.

4. Google Ads campaign types

The campaign type is the foundation of an advertising campaign. It affects where ads can appear, what kinds of ads/assets can be used, and which features and bidding strategies are available. In the Google Ads API, the campaign is represented using fields such as advertising channel type and, when applicable, advertising channel subtype.

Campaign type	Brief explanation	Common goals	API perspective
Search	Text-oriented ads shown when users search for relevant products/services on Google Search and partner surfaces.	Leads, sales, high-intent traffic	Best first campaign to learn API campaign creation.
Performance Max	One campaign designed to reach goals across Google's channels using automation and asset-	Sales, leads, conversions	High API value; uses AssetGroup and AssetGroupAsset concepts.

	based creative.		
Demand Gen	Visually rich, discovery-oriented advertising intended to create demand and drive action with potential customers.	Awareness, consideration, conversions	Important modern campaign with its own ad/asset structures.
Display	Visual advertising across eligible websites and apps in Google's Display Network.	Awareness, reach, remarketing, leads	Useful for learning visual targeting and responsive display concepts.
Shopping	Product-focused advertising driven by product/catalog information, typically connected with Merchant Center.	E-commerce sales	Important when building e-commerce advertising tools.
App	Promotes mobile apps to drive installs or other app-related goals.	Installs, engagement, pre-registration	Useful for mobile-app advertising integrations.
Video	Video advertising, primarily associated with YouTube inventory.	Awareness, views, engagement, conversions	Important reporting topic; current API creation support differs for legacy Video campaigns.
Local Services	Advertising for eligible local service businesses, designed to generate leads.	Local leads	API support is limited for campaign creation and sub-entity creation; see current restrictions.

4.1 Search campaign

A Search campaign is the clearest place to start API learning because it exposes the classic relationship among campaign, ad group, keywords, ads, budget, targeting, and reporting. Search ads are aimed at people actively searching for products or services relevant to the advertiser.

```
Search
  Campaign
    |-- Budget
    |-- Ad Group
        |-- Keywords
        |-- Responsive Search Ads
    |-- Location targeting
```

4.2 Performance Max

Performance Max (PMax) is highly automated and can reach goals across Google channels from a single campaign. Instead of a Search-style keyword-first model, developers work heavily with asset groups and assets. This makes PMax conceptually different from Search.

```
Performance Max
 Campaign
  |-- Budget
  |-- Asset Group
     |-- Headlines
     |-- Descriptions
     |-- Images / other assets
  |-- Audience / targeting signals
  |-- Campaign settings
```

4.3 Demand Gen

Demand Gen focuses on visually rich, discovery-oriented experiences and can use Google surfaces such as YouTube, Discover and Gmail, subject to the current product and channel configuration. It is a modern option for advertisers that want demand creation and visual engagement rather than only capturing existing search intent.

4.4 Display

Display campaigns use visual advertising on eligible websites and apps in Google's Display Network. This is the campaign type most closely related to the common mental model of “a business advertises on another website.” AdSense can be part of the publisher ecosystem, but Display is not the same product as AdSense.

```
Business -> Google Ads Display campaign -> eligible Display inventory -> user sees banner / responsive visual ad
```

4.5 Shopping

Shopping campaigns promote products using product information. Developers should think about a product/catalog layer, Merchant Center, product groups or listing-related controls, campaign configuration, and performance reporting.

4.6 App

App campaigns are designed to promote mobile applications. Google can use app information and automated systems to find users likely to install or engage with the app.

4.7 Video

Video campaigns are centered on video advertising. A key API caveat is that the current Google Ads API documentation states that new legacy Video campaign creation is not supported through the API; reporting on existing Video campaign data remains possible, while modern alternatives such as Demand Gen are important to understand.

4.8 Local Services

Local Services campaigns are designed to help eligible local service businesses generate leads. The current API supports retrieving and editing certain settings, budgets, bidding and targeting, but Google documents restrictions: creation/removal of Local Services campaigns and creation/removal of their sub-entities such as ad groups, ads, or criteria are not supported through the Google Ads API.

5. Campaign hierarchy

The traditional Search hierarchy is the most useful starting mental model. Other campaign types, especially Performance Max, can introduce different structures such as Asset Groups.

```
Manager Account
  |
  +-- Customer Account
      |
      +-- Campaign
          |
          +-- Campaign Budget
          +-- Campaign settings / targeting
          +-- Ad Group
              |
              +-- Keywords
              +-- Ads
```

5.1 Customer and manager account

A manager account can manage multiple client/customer accounts. When using the API, it is important to distinguish the operating customer from the login customer. The operating customer is the account whose resources you are actually reading or changing. The login customer is the account context used to establish access when working through a manager account.

```
Manager Account
ID: 1111111111
      |
      +-- Client Account
          ID: 2222222222

Example mental model:
login-customer-id = 1111111111
operating customer = 2222222222
```

6. Google Ads API fundamentals

The Google Ads API is resource-oriented. Developers work with services that manage resources and use mutation methods for many create/update/remove operations, while GoogleAdsService provides query/reporting capabilities.

API concept	What to understand
Resource	A Google Ads object such as Campaign, AdGroup, AdGroupAd, AdGroupCriterion, CampaignBudget, Asset, or ConversionAction.
Resource name	A fully qualified identifier such as customers/1234567890/campaigns/987654321.
Service	An API service that manages or queries one resource family or capability.
Mutate	The operation family used to create, update, and

	remove supported resources.
Operation	One individual create/update/remove instruction inside a mutate request.
GoogleAdsService	A central service for search/reporting queries and also bulk mutation patterns through Mutate.
GoogleAdsFieldService	Metadata discovery for fields, resources, selection/filtering capabilities, and GAQL construction.
GAQL	Google Ads Query Language used to retrieve resource and performance data.

6.1 REST and gRPC

Google Ads API documentation describes gRPC as the primary API style and also exposes REST bindings. REST is useful for learning because the request/response model is explicit: HTTP method, URL, headers, JSON body, and JSON response. Once the underlying API model is understood, the same concepts transfer to client libraries and gRPC.

```
POST https://googleads.googleapis.com/v25/customers/{customerId}/campaigns:mutate
Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN
Content-Type: application/json
```

7. Authentication concepts

Google Ads API authorization is based on OAuth 2.0. The core concepts are consent, authorization code, access token, refresh token, and the Google Cloud project associated with the OAuth application.

```
User
 |
 v
Google authorization
 |
 v
Authorization code
 |
 v
Backend exchanges code
 |
 +-- Access token
 +-- Refresh token
 |
 v
Google Ads API
```

The Google Ads OAuth scope is:

```
https://www.googleapis.com/auth/adwords
```

Access tokens are short-lived. A refresh token allows a backend to obtain new access tokens without requiring the user to authorize every API call. Google documents approximately 3,600 seconds as the access-token lifetime.

2026 developer-token change

Google sunset developer tokens on 9 September 2026. Current API access levels are associated with Google Cloud projects. Existing code may still send the old header for compatibility with some client libraries, but Google states that API servers ignore the developer-token header. Current client libraries should be checked for their version-specific behavior.

8. Creating a Search campaign through the API

The classic Search campaign creation flow is: budget -> campaign -> ad group -> keywords/criteria -> responsive search ad -> optional location targeting and other settings. Google also documents bulk mutation with GoogleAdsService.Mutate, which can create multiple related resources in one request.

8.1 Campaign creation sequence

1. Create a CampaignBudget with the desired daily amount.
2. Create a Search Campaign, normally starting in PAUSED status during setup.
3. Create an AdGroup linked to that campaign.
4. Create AdGroupCriterion resources for keywords.
5. Create an AdGroupAd containing a ResponsiveSearchAdInfo object.
6. Add location targeting and other campaign settings as needed.
7. Validate the configuration and review errors before enabling the campaign.

8.2 Budget and micros

Google Ads API represents currency amounts in micros. One currency unit is represented as 1,000,000 micros. For example, a conceptual ₹500 daily budget corresponds to 500,000,000 micros.

```
₹500 × 1,000,000 = 500,000,000 micros
```

8.3 Conceptual budget request

```
{
 "operations": [
  {
   "create": {
    "name": "AI Chatbot Daily Budget",
    "amountMicros": "500000000"
   }
  }
 ]
}
```

8.4 Conceptual campaign request

```
{
 "operations": [
  {
   "create": {
    "name": "AI Chatbot Search Campaign",
    "status": "PAUSED",
    "advertisingChannelType": "SEARCH",
    "campaignBudget": "customers/1234567890/campaignBudgets/123456789"
   }
  }
 ]
}
```

The exact set of required fields depends on the campaign configuration and the current API version. Always validate against the current versioned reference rather than relying on an old tutorial payload.

8.5 Conceptual ad group request

```
{
 "operations": [
  {
   "create": {
    "name": "AI Chatbot Software",
    "campaign": "customers/1234567890/campaigns/987654321"
   }
  }
 ]
}
```

9. Keywords and match types

Keywords are central to classic Search campaigns. In the API, keywords are generally represented through AdGroupCriterion and its KeywordInfo configuration.

Match type	Example notation	High-level idea
Exact	[ai chatbot]	Tighter matching around a specific search intent.
Phrase	"ai chatbot"	Captures searches containing the phrase/meaning under Google's current matching behavior.
Broad	ai chatbot	Wider matching that gives Google more room to find relevant searches.

9.1 Negative keywords

Negative keywords are exclusions. For example, a paid AI SaaS product might exclude searches such as “free”, “jobs”, or “course” when those queries are not commercially relevant. Google Ads API supports negative criteria and shared negative keyword list concepts.

```
Target keywords:
 "ai chatbot"
 "business chatbot"

Potential exclusions:
 free
 jobs
 course
```

9.2 Search-term thinking

A keyword is not the same thing as every real user search that may trigger an ad. In reporting and optimization, developers should learn search-term reporting, identify irrelevant traffic, and feed learnings back into targeting and exclusions.

10. Responsive Search Ads

Responsive Search Ads (RSAs) let the advertiser provide multiple headlines and descriptions. Google can test combinations and favor combinations that perform well. The API represents the RSA content under ResponsiveSearchAdInfo inside an Ad, which is then contained by an AdGroupAd.

RSA element	Current documented requirement / limit
Headlines	At least 3 and up to 15 unique headlines; up to 30 characters each.
Descriptions	At least 2 and up to 4 unique descriptions; up to 90 characters each.
Final URL	At least one final URL is required.
Pinning	Headlines/descriptions can be pinned to designated positions when stricter placement is necessary.

10.1 Conceptual RSA payload

```
{
 "finalUrls": [
  "https://example.com/ai-chatbot"
 ],
 "responsiveSearchAd": {
  "headlines": [
   {"text": "AI Chatbot For Business"},
   {"text": "Automate Customer Support"},
   {"text": "Build Smarter AI Workflows"}
  ],
  "descriptions": [
   {"text": "Automate customer conversations with an AI chatbot."},
   {"text": "Build powerful AI experiences for your business."}
  ]
 }
}
```

10.2 Why pinning exists

Pinning lets an advertiser force specific assets into designated headline or description positions. It gives control at the cost of reducing Google's freedom to test combinations. Use it when there is a real business, legal, or structural reason to control placement.

11. Targeting

Targeting determines which users, places, devices, audiences, or contexts a campaign is eligible to reach. The available controls depend on the campaign type.

Targeting area	Examples	Typical API resources / concepts
Locations	India, Maharashtra, Mumbai, radius around a point	CampaignCriterion, GeoTargetConstantService, location criteria
Keywords	Search terms	AdGroupCriterion / KeywordInfo

Audiences	Audience lists and segments	CampaignCriterion / audience-related resources
Demographics	Age, gender and other supported demographic controls	CampaignCriterion / AdGroupCriterion and current targeting schemas
Devices	Mobile, desktop and other supported device categories	CampaignCriterion / bid and targeting controls
Exclusions	Negative keywords, excluded locations/audiences where supported	Negative criteria and exclusion resources

11.1 Location targeting flow

```
Location name
  |
  v
GeoTargetConstantService
  |
  v
Geo target constant / criterion
  |
  v
CampaignCriterion
  |
  v
Campaign targets that location
```

Google documents SuggestGeoTargetConstants as a way to discover targetable locations. The returned information can then be used when constructing campaign targeting criteria.

12. GAQL and reporting

GAQL means Google Ads Query Language. It is the main query language you should learn for reading campaign and performance information from the API. The style looks similar to SQL, but the available resources, fields, segments, metrics, and relationships follow Google Ads API rules.

12.1 Basic campaign query

```
SELECT
  campaign.id,
  campaign.name,
  campaign.status
FROM campaign
WHERE campaign.status != 'REMOVED'
ORDER BY campaign.id
```

12.2 Campaign performance query

```
SELECT
  campaign.id,
  campaign.name,
  metrics.impressions,
  metrics.clicks,
  metrics.ctr,
  metrics.cost_micros,
  metrics.conversions
FROM campaign
WHERE segments.date DURING LAST_30_DAYS
```

12.3 Core performance metrics

Metric	Meaning
Impressions	How many recorded ad impressions occurred.
Clicks	How many recorded clicks occurred.
CTR	Clicks / impressions.
Cost	Advertising cost; API cost fields are commonly represented in micros.
Conversions	Tracked conversion actions attributed under the account settings and reporting rules.
CPA	Cost per conversion/action; often used to compare efficiency.
ROAS	Conversion value / advertising cost, commonly used for e-commerce or value-based optimization.

12.4 Search vs SearchStream

Google Ads API provides Search and SearchStream query methods. Search returns results in a paginated model. SearchStream provides streamed retrieval that can be useful for larger result sets. The correct choice depends on data volume and application behavior.

12.5 Field discovery

Do not guess GAQL fields. Use Google Ads API field metadata and the Interactive Query Builder / field reference to confirm whether a field is selectable, filterable, sortable, or compatible with the resource and segments you are querying.

13. Mutations, batching, validation and field masks

Mutate requests can contain one or many operations. A mutation operation can create, update, or remove a supported resource. Learning how to build safe mutations is one of the most important intermediate skills.

13.1 One operation vs many operations

```
One request
  +-- Create Keyword A
  +-- Create Keyword B
  +-- Create Keyword C
  +-- Create Keyword D
```

Batching multiple operations can reduce request overhead. For larger automation systems, batching must still respect current quotas, operation limits, validation behavior, and error handling rules.

13.2 Validate-only

When supported by the mutate request, validate-only mode lets you validate a request without applying it. A practical development pattern is: construct -> validate -> fix errors -> execute -> record the resulting resource names.

```
{
  "validateOnly": true,
  "operations": [ ... ]
}
```

13.3 Partial failure

For suitable mutate requests, partial failure can allow valid operations to succeed even when another operation fails. This is valuable when processing lists of independent items, such as multiple keywords, although your application must explicitly interpret and report per-operation failures.

```
Keyword A -> SUCCESS
Keyword B -> SUCCESS
Keyword C -> ERROR
Keyword D -> SUCCESS
```

13.4 Temporary resource names

Advanced mutate requests can use temporary resource names to let related resources refer to objects that are being created in the same request. This is useful when a campaign, ad group, keywords, and ads are logically part of one creation transaction.

13.5 Field masks

Updates generally use field masks so the API knows exactly which fields should change. This is safer than treating an update as a full replacement of every field.

```
resourceName = customers/1234567890/campaigns/987654321
updateMask = status,biddingStrategy...
```

14. Error handling and debugging

Google Ads errors are structured. A useful debugging process combines HTTP status, Google Ads error category, specific error code/details, the request context, and the Google request identifier when available.

Error area	Typical meaning
Authentication / OAuth	Token, consent, credential, or authorization-flow problem.
Authorization	The user or customer context does not have permission to perform the requested action.
Campaign / Ad Group / Ad errors	The requested resource configuration violates field or campaign rules.
Policy violation	The content or configuration has an advertising-policy issue.
Field error	A required, invalid, incompatible, or unsupported field value was supplied.
Quota / rate limiting	Too many requests or operations relative to current API limits.
Validation error	The combination of settings is not valid for the selected campaign/resource type.

14.1 Do not expose raw provider errors

Your backend should translate provider-specific failures into stable application-level errors. Keep detailed Google error data in secure logs and return a safe, useful message to the frontend.

```
{
  "success": false,
  "code": "CAMPAIGN_CREATION_FAILED",
  "message": "Campaign could not be created.",
  "requestId": "..."
}
```

14.2 A useful debugging checklist

- Confirm the operating customer ID and, when applicable, the login customer ID.
- Confirm the resource hierarchy: budget -> campaign -> ad group -> ad/criterion.
- Check current API-version documentation for required fields and deprecated resources.
- Validate the request before executing it when the API supports validate-only.
- Inspect the detailed Google Ads error rather than stopping at a generic HTTP status.

15. Security and production practices

Google Ads credentials are sensitive. The browser should not receive long-lived OAuth secrets or refresh tokens. Token and account credentials should be protected on the server side, encrypted at rest where appropriate, and removed when no longer needed.

- Never hard-code OAuth client secrets or refresh tokens in source code.

- Do not commit credential files or .env files containing secrets to Git.
- Encrypt sensitive refresh tokens in the application database.
- Limit internal access to advertising credentials and customer identifiers.
- Keep audit records for important campaign and budget changes.
- Apply application-level authorization before allowing a user to modify a customer account.
- Use paused campaigns during multi-step campaign creation until the final configuration has been reviewed.

15.1 Resource names

Store full Google Ads resource names where practical, not only numeric IDs. Resource names are frequently required when updating or linking objects.

```
customers/1234567890/campaigns/987654321
customers/1234567890/adGroups/555555
customers/1234567890/adGroupCriteria/555555~777777
```

15.2 Application/database state

A production system should maintain its own record of the Google Ads objects it created or manages. At minimum, your application often needs the relationship between your internal entity, user/organization, Google customer, Google resource name, state, and timestamps.

16. AI + Google Ads automation concepts

For an AI-focused developer, Google Ads becomes especially interesting when an LLM generates structured campaign ideas while deterministic backend code performs validation and controlled API mutations.

```
User request
  |
  v
LLM
  |
  v
Structured campaign plan
  |
  v
Validation + business rules
  |
  v
Google Ads service layer
  |
  v
Google Ads API
```

16.1 Example AI-generated campaign plan

```
{
 "campaign": {
  "name": "AI Chatbot Search",
  "type": "SEARCH",
  "dailyBudget": 1000
 },
 "adGroup": {
  "name": "AI Chatbot"
 },
 "keywords": [
  {"text": "ai chatbot", "matchType": "PHRASE"},
  {"text": "business chatbot", "matchType": "PHRASE"}
 ],
 "ad": {
  "headlines": [
   "AI Chatbot For Business",
   "Automate Customer Support",
   "Build Smarter AI Workflows"
  ],
  "descriptions": [
   "Automate customer conversations with an AI chatbot.",
   "Build powerful AI experiences for your business."
  ]
 }
}
```

16.2 Validation must remain deterministic

An AI model should not be allowed to bypass authorization or campaign safety rules. The model can generate intent and content; the backend should enforce customer access, allowed budget ranges, required fields, URL rules, naming conventions, and any other application constraints.

```
LLM output
  |
  +-- Schema validation
  +-- Authorization
  +-- Budget rules
  +-- Required fields
  +-- API validation
  |
  v
Execute mutation
```

17. Learning roadmap from beginner to intermediate

Stage	Learn these topics	Target outcome
Beginner 1	Google Ads, AdSense, advertiser vs publisher, account, campaign, ad group, keyword, ad	Explain the platform in simple language.
Beginner 2	Campaign types, Search hierarchy, Performance Max asset groups, Display, Demand Gen, Shopping, App	Choose the right campaign family for a business goal.
Beginner 3	OAuth concepts, customer IDs, resource names, REST/gRPC, mutate, Search	Understand how the API is organized.
Intermediate 1	Campaign creation, ad groups, keywords, RSA, location targeting	Create a complete Search campaign programmatically.
Intermediate 2	GAQL, SearchStream, metrics, segments, field metadata	Build reports and dashboards.
Intermediate 3	Batching, partial failure, validate-only, field masks, temp resources	Create safer and more efficient automation.
Intermediate 4	Security, authorization, audit logs, quotas, retries, synchronization	Design a production-capable integration.
Intermediate 5	AI-generated campaign plans + deterministic validation	Combine LLMs with controlled advertising automation.

17.1 First API project goal

A strong first milestone is to understand and then implement the complete lifecycle of a Search campaign: budget -> campaign -> ad group -> keyword -> responsive search ad -> targeting -> reporting. Once that flow is clear, Performance Max is the next major learning step because it introduces an asset-group-centered model.

17.2 What to learn later

- Performance Max in depth: AssetGroup, AssetGroupAsset, audience signals and campaign-level controls.
- Conversions and offline conversion imports.
- Advanced targeting and exclusions.
- Large-account synchronization, queues, caching, retries and quota-aware batch processing.
- Experiments, value-based bidding, optimization signals, and current AI-driven campaign features.

18. Current API and deprecation notes

Google Ads API v25

Google Ads API v25 is the current major release documented in this guide. v25 was released on 22 July 2026; v25.1 and v25.2 are minor releases with additional features and updates.

18.1 Developer tokens

Google states that developer tokens were sunset on 9 September 2026. API access levels are now associated with Google Cloud projects. The old developer-token header is optional and ignored by the API servers; current client libraries should be checked for their version-specific compatibility behavior.

18.2 Smart campaigns

Creating new Smart campaigns is deprecated starting 23 September 2026 and is no longer supported in the current API path. Existing Smart campaign settings can still be updated according to the current documentation. Avoid building new learning flows around old Smart Campaign creation tutorials.

18.3 Call-only ads

Google documents Call-only ads as deprecated for new creation, with existing call-only ads supported only for a limited period. The recommended direction is Responsive Search Ads with call assets.

18.4 Video campaign API support

The current API documentation distinguishes legacy Video campaign management from newer campaign approaches. Do not assume that every Video workflow shown in an older tutorial can still create new campaigns through the API. Verify the current versioned documentation and consider Demand Gen where appropriate.

18.5 Local Services API limitations

Local Services has meaningful API limitations: current documentation says the API can retrieve and edit certain campaign/budget/settings and report on leads, but it does not support creating/removing Local Services campaigns or creating/removing their sub-entities.

19. Official references

The URLs below are the primary Google documentation sources used to keep this guide aligned with the current API generation. Google changes capabilities and deprecations over time, so treat these as the source of truth when implementing.

Google Ads API campaign documentation

Campaigns overview

Search campaigns getting started

Google Ads API ad types

Responsive Search Ads overview

Create Responsive Search Ads

GAQL overview

Reporting overview

Location targeting

Developer token / current access model

Smart campaigns

Local Services campaigns

Google Ads API release notes

OAuth overview

Client libraries

Google Ads API reference v25

Quick reference: the core Search API flow

```
Customer
  -> CampaignBudget
  -> Campaign (SEARCH)
  -> AdGroup
  -> AdGroupCriterion (Keyword)
  -> AdGroupAd (ResponsiveSearchAd)
  -> CampaignCriterion (e.g. location)
  -> GoogleAdsService / GAQL reporting
```

Remember

Google Ads API development is not only about creating ads. A complete integration also needs account context, authorization, resource relationships, validation, reporting, security, error handling, and current-version awareness.